September 12, 1950, he suggested this to me, and asked if I would be willing to help and make it "Boyd and Asimov."

The suggestion intrigued and delighted me. I had an instant vision of having a complex, authoritative, and large textbook lined up on the shelf along with my science-fiction novels, thus lending myself new prestige as a double-threat man, both fiction and nonfiction.

Besides, it was something new and therefore something interesting. There was only one catch: Bill was a full professor and his time was his own. I, however, had Dr. Walker as my academic employer and Dr. Lemon as my research employer, and they might not be willing to have me spend my time on a textbook. Boyd suggested we ask Walker directly, and the next day we did.

His reaction took us by surprise. He did more than give me permission. He joined the project and it became "Walker, Boyd, and Asimov." I don't know that Boyd was very pleased to have his seniority bumped like that, but Dr. Walker was a very good biochemist and his collaboration was bound to help the book. Besides, if Dr. Walker was part of the project I didn't see that Dr. Lemon could object.

Walker got to work at once. That very night we were invited to his house to help compose a letter to Williams & Wilkins, the textbook publisher whom Walker thought would be best for the purpose. It was

on that occasion that I met Mrs. Walker, whom I describe in my diary as "a tough and talkative woman/' which is exactly right. I then added a calm, "We drove, of course."

We made up a list of chapters, assigned one third to each of us and, by September 20, a Williams & Wilkins representative, Dick Hoover, was over to see us. We were in business. 8

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Henry Lemon, intent on improving my technical background, signed me up for a week's course in New York on electrophoresis, a technique for separating complex protein molecules in blood and elsewhere—and for purifying proteins such as enzymes.

I was not at all enthusiastic about this because I had long come to the conclusion that nothing was ever going to make a good lab technician out of